



Steering Committee Meeting Minutes



Ohio River Trail: Pittsburgh to Coraopolis Feasibility Study

Municipality Meeting

May 2, 2012

Father Ryan Arts Center, McKees Rocks, PA

Meeting Notes and Comments from RWG:

1. Around 35-40 attended the meeting
2. County Executive Rich Fitzgerald supports the plan and opened the event
3. Congressman Mike Doyle sent Domenick Carroll to attend
4. Local municipalities support the concept
5. Allegheny County, PEC, Friends and Mackin presented
6. Montour Trail has a well established security group that tours the alignment- volunteer members working with Police- contact Jesse Forquer (Robinson Twp Vice Chair- Board of Commissioners)
7. Trinity Commercial Development has plans to building an industrial park in McKees Rocks; along the railroad from the shopping center toward and into the Bottoms- contact Craig Rippole. They own Eat-n-Park, shopping center and portions of future industrial park land. Trinity also has an interest in creating a boat launch(s) area along Chartiers Creek at confluence and/or behind Eat-n-Park.
 - a. Mackin to set meeting to review alignment and Trinity plans for development.
8. Neville Island contact- Dorothy Antonelli represents Neville Green (group to beatify roads, and public space on Neville Island). She lives on the island and husband owns a civil engineering firm- Nire Engineering?
 - a. Mackin to set meeting to review alignment and ped-bike-traffic data already collected by Neville Green (review parallel parking along roads too).
9. The RED alignment along Neville is owned by many others (alignment along channel side) and is not feasible according to participant at meeting.
10. Next Steps:
 - a. Committee Meeting to officially begin the project (Kick-Off Meeting)
 - i. Refer to Scope for items in Kick-Off Mtg
 - b. Collect Data:
 - i. Maps-
 1. County GIS Data
 2. PennDOT

3. Local Municipal Maps
 4. SPC- future projects
 5. Bike Pgh
 6. Friend of the Riverfront
 7. Developer's future projects
- c. Quantify and Qualify Alignment Segments with the following:
- i. Road Classification- Speed, ADT, "collectors, locals, etc"
 - ii. Road Ownership
 - iii. Right of Way and Roadway Dimension
 - iv. Sidewalk Dimension/Corridor Dimensions (façade to façade)
- d. Meet with locals to review details of proposed alignments

PLEASE SIGN IN

Ohio River Trail
BRC-RTP-16-183

First	Last	Email	Address 1	Address 2	State	Zip
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Jim	VITALE	JVITALE@MOUNTAIN.COM				
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John	CRANGIARULO	Mykeas Rocks BORO				
Bill	DeMONACO	Coropolis				
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Ray	McCutcheon	manager@coropolispa.com				
KEVIN	PERL	KEVIN.ALF@VERIZON.NET				
Kim	Perl	KAP.ggf@verizon.net				

Please Sign in.

Ohio River Trail BRC-RTP-16-183

First	Last	Email	Address 1	Address 2	State	Zip
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Ohio River Trail

BRC-RTP-16-183

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MEETING MINUTES

Ohio River Trail: Pittsburgh to Coraopolis Feasibility Study
Stakeholder Meeting, June 18, 2012
St. Mary Ukrainian Orthodox Church

- Attendance- REFER TO ATTACHED
- General Description of the Project and the Schedule (Tom Baxter and Hannah Hardy)
- Review Project Status and Brief Members on Current Alignments- “on-road alignments with local loops in community” (Bob Genter)
 - o Completed and Current Tasks
 - Field view of alignments, Municipal Meeting with County Executive, Data Collection
 - PRIORITY ALIGNMENT- CONTINUE DISCUSSION WITH DOT FOR WEST END RAILROAD ALIGNMENT- INVESTIGATE OPTIONS FOR USE (ELEVATED BIKEWAY)
 - o Next Tasks
 - Interviews (SEND PKG TO INTERVIEWEES PRIOR TO CALL)
 - Property Ownership and Easements Investigation. PROP OWNERS ADDED TO LIST AND OWNERSHIP OF RT 51 STONE WALL TO BE INVESTIGATED (THERESA S.); ALSO P&LE EASEMENT- SPACE BTWN ROW TO BE INVESTIGATED (CRAIG R.).
 - Field Reviews of Alignments with local communities
 - Draft Plan then Final Plan- FINAL DOC TO DESCRIBE EASEMENT FOR USE AND MAINTENANCE
- Confirm and Complete Stakeholder List (THE LIST WAS REVIEWED, EDITED, SUMMARIZED AND COMPLETED- HANNAH TO DISTRIBUTE)
- What are we missing? Who else should be involved? (NO COMMENTS OR ADDITIONS)

- Meeting Dates- Tentative dates for 2 public meetings. TWO DRAFT MEETINGS TO BE SCHEDULED IN LATE JULY OR EARLY AUGUST, AT TWO DIFFERENT LOCATIONS IN CORRIDOR. 1-FINAL MEETING TO BE SCHEDULED LATER- MAY BE CENTRAL TO CORRIDOR.

NAME

EMAIL

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Thomas Baxter F.O.R. thomas@friends of the riverfront.org
Sam Thomas F.O.R. Sam Woods thomas@gmail.com
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MEETING MINUTES
Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector Feasibility Study
(Pittsburgh to Coraopolis)

Re- Committee Steering Meeting; December 11, 2012 at 9 am @ 555 Broadway Avenue, McKees Rocks, PA

Attendance- REFER TO ATTACHED

Presentation of Feasibility Study Findings and Recommendations (PowerPoint presentation by Bob Genter)

Discussion of findings and recommendations – with suggested modifications

1. The Shoppes at Chartiers Crossing – Notes and graphics should be added to the rendering that show improved pedestrian pathways from the parking spaces to the building frontage. Signs alerting pedestrians that they are entering the bike lane may also be warranted. It was noted that The Shoppes at Chartiers Crossing are a part of the McKees Rock's "Downtown District" and that ped/bike improvements should be implemented.
2. Suggestion was made to incorporate an "OK" painted below the Sharrow to indicate to drivers that it is acceptable for bicyclists to share the roadway with vehicles.
3. Suggestion to include "Zips" in the bike lane striping to warn motorists if they encroach; similar to what the State has incorporated into their center lane striping.
4. A question was asked as to why the stretch of Grand Avenue (from Memorial Park eastbound) was not chosen as the Direct Route. Response was- The heavy industrial use of this roadway, several driveway curb cuts, heavy truck traffic, and multiple railroad crossings made this stretch less feasible than continuing the bicycle lane condition on Neville Road. Saturday traffic vs weekday traffic is different; we can recommend this route be signed as local loop route for weekend use.
5. Discussion of the proposed route along West Carson (SR51) between McKees Rock and the City of Pittsburgh- the newly designed S.R. 51 that has been submitted for final approval by PennDOT (JMT). The design delineates 2- 14 wide lanes, an east and a west

- bound; and a center 10' turning lane. The City is to mark 'sharrows' and install signs after construction.
- a. Mackin requested the committee direct what the report will state about the subject Rt 51 design section- accept the design or make recommendations for improvements?
 - b. Mackin recommends the study show improvements to make the ped-bike facility safer.
 - i. Options 1- construct a separated/protected two-way cycle track and pedestrian sidewalk on the river-side of S.R. 51. Change traffic lanes from 14' to 12' wide each and eliminate the 10' center lane except at the Bus Way and Corliss Tunnel; to reduce length of impact to current design section.
 - ii. Options 2- construct a separated/protected 5' wide bike lane adjacent to sidewalk, westbound direction, and a sharrow condition eastbound. This will require widening of the current design section.
 - iii. The recommended design between Corliss and McKees Rocks- consider a 5' bike lane up hill, a sharrow down hill; roadway to be 2- 11' lanes with 10' center turning lane; all within the same 38' wide section.
 - c. The Committee discussed strategies on how to approach the City/PennDOT regarding this segment of S.R. 51.
 - i. Mackin is to contact the ped/bike coordinator at PennDOT Central Office to discuss the matter and request he comes to PGH for the City meeting.
 - ii. Tom Baxter to contact the City of Pittsburgh and Allegheny County to contact Local State Representatives. The Strategy is to gain acceptance from local Municipal Leadership with the alignment between McKees Rocks and Coraopolis, and approach the City/PennDOT to discuss improved ped/bike facilities on upcoming roadway project.
6. Sara Walfoort (SPC) discussed her involvement on the Transportation Technical Committee, specifically that the Fleming Bridge will be re-decked in the upcoming year.

7. Sara suggested that this report indicate the importance of incorporating ped/bike facilities into the design and construction to provide safe and accessible accommodations for all users.
8. Sam Thomas is to set the public open house meeting date and secure the location sometime in January
9. There will be a Public Meeting (open house) to present the feasibility study findings and recommendations in January 2013 at the Father Ryan Arts Center in McKees Rocks; a specific date and time have not been set. Mackin will make a brief formal presentation to the participants at the onset of the meeting, and administer break-out groups to allow individuals to view and discuss the Direct Route, Alternate Route and Local Loop within their specific communities.

THREE RIVERS HERITAGE TRAIL COMMITTEE MEETING			DEC. 11, 2012
NAME	EMAIL	ASSOCIATION	
Lance Welliver	lwelliver@moonparks.org	Moon Township	
Jeff Ziegler	jziegler@moontwp.com	MOON TOWNSHIP	
Jeanne Creech	jcreesch@moontwp.com	Moon Township	
Tom Baxter	thomas@friendsoftheriverfront.org		
SAM JAMPETRO	SAM.JAMPETRO@CORYFOUNDATION.ORG	CORAOPOLIS	
Tom Toomey	tom_toomey@netzero.net	Coraopolis	
Dana Cravotta	dana.cravotta@alleghenycountypa.gov	AZ	
Hannah Hardy	hhardy@pecpa.org	PEC	
Dorothy Antonelli	DJANE13@verizon.net	Neville Green	
DAVID KEER	dkeer@nevilletownship.vt	NEVILLE TWP.	
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TARIS VREEK	tvreek@mac.com	Mckas Rocks/Stowe	
Sara Walfoort	Swalfoort@spcregion.org	SPC	
DENNIS PFEIFFER	Dennis.Pfeiffer@PNC.COM		
	MONTHOUR TRAIL COUNCIL		
Bill Moldovan	wmoldovan@mackinengineering.com	Mackin Eng.	
BUB GENTLE	rwg@mackinengineering.com	MACKIN ENG.	



Field Meeting Minutes with Municipalities





Three Rivers Heritage Trail (Ohio River) Feasibility Study

Re- Field Review with municipal and local leaders

August 29, 2012; 8 am @ Neville and 9.30 am @ Coraopolis

This field meeting is to review the draft alignment and gather opinions, issues, and concerns for consideration and improvement.

This is an extension of the Three Rivers Heritage Trail- a bicycle system connecting the City of Pittsburgh, west toward Coraopolis and the Montour Trail. The alignment is an on-road system.

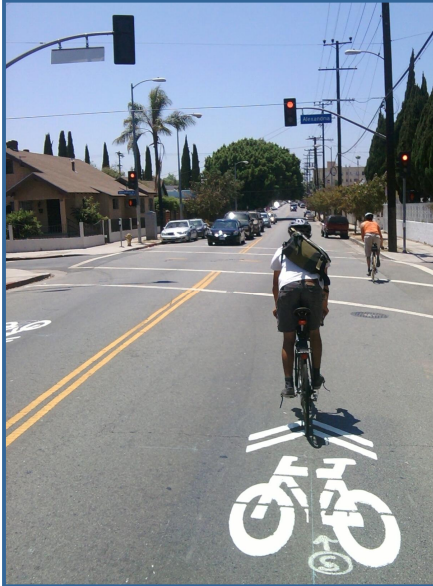
Neville Island- the alignment proposes to use the road shoulder along Neville Road and a 'share the road' condition, on Grand Ave. Each bridge will be proposed for pedestrian crossing improvements and upgrades.

Coraopolis- the alignment is an enhancement to BicyclePA Route-A, along Fourth and Fifth Avenues, for safety and wayfinding. Also, alternative routes and local loops are proposed throughout the community. State Street is proposed as an alternative route (less traffic) to BicyclePA. And the connection to the Montour Trail is proposed as a split route system (ramp and underpass) to connect to the off-road trail.

Improvements to include:

1. Sign and Pavement Markings-
 - a. BIKE ROUTES
 - b. BIKE 'SHARROWS'
 - c. BIKE LANES
2. Routing Signs- Distance, Direction, Destinations, (Confirmation of Turns)
3. Pedestrian signal and cross walk upgrades and enhancements
4. MUTCD Safety and Warning Signs- *Alert Motorists*
5. Alternate Routes- offer users a lower traffic volume route
6. Local Loops- lower traffic volume routes & connections to community facilities.





Example of Sharrow- Share the Road Markings



Example of Bike Lane- 5' min. width at curb (4' min. without curb)



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (Ohio River) Feasibility Study

Re- Field Review with municipal and local leaders

September 21, 2012; 11 am @ McKee's Rocks and 1 pm @ Stowe Township

This field meeting is to review the draft alignment and gather opinions, issues, and concerns for consideration and improvement.

This is an extension of the Three Rivers Heritage Trail; *an on-road bicycle system* connecting the City of Pittsburgh, west toward Coraopolis and the Montour Trail.

McKees Rocks- The Main Bicycle Route Alignment traverses Route 51 (Stanhope & Chartier's Avenue) and proposes Local Loop and Alternative Routes as options to cyclists (as lower traffic volume routes and community connections respectively). The Local Loop is along River Road and through the 'Bottoms' and the Alternative Route is Locust.

The Main Alignment traverses Route 51 (Island Avenue). Island Ave. is proposed for a "road diet" to accommodate bike lanes on each side. The bikeway becomes a Shared Lane Marking ('Sharrows'), to maintain parking and travel lane width, as it approaches the McKees Rocks Bridge.

Stowe Township- An Alternative Route is proposed under the bridge to clear the high traffic intersection. The Alt. Rt. follows Harriet, Page, to McKee, to Margaret Streets, and back to Island Ave. (Rt 51). A 'Sharrow' marking system is used to continue the alignment toward the Fleming Park Bridge.

The proposed bike facility uses both Bike Lanes and Shared Lane Markings.

- Bike Lanes would be used where the roadway is wide enough to accommodate the current auto traffic and allow a 4'-5' bike lane; typically used where traffic volumes and speeds are higher.
- Shared Lane Markings are proposed at narrow corridor conditions, to maintain parallel parking, and where speeds are 35 MPH or less.



Recommended Improvements:

1. **Sign and Pavement Markings-**

- a. BIKE ROUTES (SIGNED ONLY ALIGNMENTS)
- b. BIKE 'SHARROWS' (SHARED LANE MARKING- ON THE ROAD)
- c. BIKE LANES (OUTSIDE OF THE TRAVEL LANE)

2. **Routing Signs-** Distance, Direction, Destinations, (Confirmation of Turns)

3. **Pedestrian signal and cross walk upgrades and enhancements**

4. **MUTCD Safety and Warning Signs-** *Alert Motorists*

5. **Alternate Routes-** offer cyclist a lower traffic volume route

6. **Local Loops-** connections to communities



Example of 'Sharrow'- Shared Lane Markings

Example of Bike Lane- 5' min. width
at curb (4' min. without curb)





Additional Letters to Municipalities





Mackin Engineering Company
R.I.D.C. Park West
117 Industry Drive
Pittsburgh, PA 15275-1015
Phone: (412) 788-0472
Fax: (412) 787-3588

April 11, 2013

Mr. Patrick F. Hassett
Deputy Director
City of Pittsburgh
Department of Public Works
414 Grant Street
Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania 15219

RE: Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector
Draft Report Documents
Mackin Project No. 4920

Dear Mr. Hassett:

Tom Baxter of Friends of the Riverfront requested that we send you draft copy excerpts from the Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector Feasibility Study. This is for your review and comment for the connector trail segments within the City. Please find enclosed the Executive Summary, trail segment descriptions, and three (3) renderings.

The report recommends a separated trail system and offers alternatives for lane changes similar to the new design between the West End Bridge and Stanhope Street in McKees Rocks.

A safe trail connection for walkers and cyclists between Pittsburgh and the City's west end neighborhoods will offer multiple transportation choices to all citizens regardless of age, ability, or socio-economic status; provide for healthier travel choices; and increase access to employment centers and community resources.

Your continued support in making our communities better places to live, work and play is appreciated. Thank you for your assistance.

Sincerely,

MACKIN ENGINEERING COMPANY

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads 'RW Genter'.

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
rwg@mackinengineering.com

RWG/nal

cc: Mr. Thomas Baxter

Enclosure

September 26, 2012

Taris A. Vrcek, Executive Director
McKees Rocks Community Development Corporation
711 Chartiers Avenue
McKees Rocks, PA 15136

Mr. Vrcek,

Thank you for attending the Three Rivers Heritage Trail Feasibility Study field review last week in McKees Rocks.

The purpose of the feasibility study is to determine the viability for an on-road bicycle system to connect the City of Pittsburgh to Coraopolis and the Montour Trail system. The study proposes improvements for cyclists and pedestrians within each town along the project corridor.

As we discussed, municipalities should consider all new developments, infrastructure projects, and roadway maintenance projects as opportunities to better link community facilities. Capital projects should consider provisions for bike lanes, share the road markings, and sidewalk extensions to re-connect the city street grid.

A walk-able and bike-able community offers multiple transportation choices to all citizens regardless of socio-economic status. This is an opportunity to re-create a complete street system and connect the community by providing transportation choices from homes to places of business, to shops, to community centers, and to recreation sites.

Your continued support in making our communities better places to live, work and play is commendable.

Sincerely,
Bob

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company
117 Industry Drive, RIDC Parkwest
Pgh, PA 15275
rwg@mackinengineering.com



Mackin Engineering Company
R.I.D.C. Park West
117 Industry Drive
Pittsburgh, PA 15275-1015
Phone: (412) 788-0472
Fax: (412) 787-3588

December 17, 2012

Mr. Thomas Baxter
Friends of the Riverfront
33 Terminal Way
Pittsburgh, PA 15219

RE: Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector
Fleming Park Bridge Repairs and Upgrades
Mackin Engineering Company
Mackin Project No. 4920

Dear Mr. Baxter:

This letter is in response to Sarah Walfoort's notice that construction work has been scheduled for the Fleming Park Bridge. We recommend the committee draft a letter of support for the needed pedestrian and bicycle improvements on this important structure prior to the County beginning their plans.

Listed below is information to help you craft a letter of request for improvements, for both pedestrian and bicycle facilities:

As you may be aware, the Fleming Park Bridge is a critical link in the Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector- a pedestrian and bicycle connector trail system linking together seven communities between Pittsburgh and Coraopolis; and directly connecting to the Montour Trail (a 45 mile trail connecting to the 300+ mile Great Allegheny Passage Trail).

Pedestrian and Bicycle Recommendations for the Fleming Park Bridge-

The west end of the Fleming Park Bridge requires pedestrian crossing improvements at the Calgon driveway and signalized intersection. Improvements are recommended for both people who walk and people who ride bikes.

Eastbound bicyclists could cross Neville Road at the existing signalized intersection and use the sidewalk; or share the road and traverse the bridge with traffic. Cyclists would be signed to walk if using the bridge sidewalk.

The bridge is recommended to be marked with share the road pavement markings ('sharrows') and signed- Share the Road, and as a bike route. The bridge lanes are recommended to be re-marked as 11' wide lanes and with wider shoulders.

Intersection improvements to include:

- ADA upgrades at shoulder and curb ramps*
- ADA accessible routes from the sidewalk to road shoulder*

- *Push buttons*
- *Countdown pedestrian signal heads*
- *Pavement markings*
- *Ahead and crossing signs (to alert motorists for peds and bikes at crossing)*

Bicycle improvements would include a widened curb ramp to access the bridge sidewalk and signs to 'dismount and walk bikes'.

Recommendations for the Neville Road Approach-

The direct route is proposed to be an on-road system extending through Neville Island using Neville Road and Grand Avenue to reach Coraopolis.

Options for pedestrian & bikeway improvements to include:

- 1. Sign and mark the existing roadway shoulder as a 5' bike lane. The shoulder is recommended to be improved by resurfacing the area to create a smooth lane with 2% cross-slope; walkers would use the remaining shoulder. The lane is to be signed for No Parking.*
- 2. A 'road diet' and the installation of 4' bike lanes on each side of the road is the second option. The road lanes would be repainted to 11' wide each- still providing four lanes of traffic, a median, and road shoulders. The bike lanes would be constructed to overlap 2' of the road and 2' on the shoulder; walkers would use the shoulders.*

A walk-able and bike-able community offers multiple transportation choices to all citizens regardless of age, ability, or socio-economic status; provides for healthier travel choices (walking and bicycling); and, increases access to employment centers and community resources.

Your continued support in making our communities better places to live, work and play is commendable.

Please contact me, if you have questions or comments.

Sincerely,

MACKIN ENGINEERING COMPANY

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "RW Genter".

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
rwg@mackinengineering.com



Mackin Engineering Company
R.I.D.C. Park West
117 Industry Drive
Pittsburgh, PA 15275-1015
Phone: (412) 788-0472
Fax: (412) 787-3588

December 18, 2012

Mr. Patrick F. Hassett
Assistant Director, Bureau of Engineering and Construction
City of Pittsburgh
Department of Public Works
414 Grant Street
Pittsburgh, PA 15219

RE: Three Rivers Heritage Trail Connector
Draft Report Documents
Mackin Project No. 4920

Dear Mr. Hassett:

Please find enclosed the draft executive summary, corridor maps, and recommendation graphics for the subject feasibility study. The report is not finished, but we wanted to supply you with some background information and ask for your support of this important project.

The purpose of the feasibility study is to determine the viability for an on-road bicycle system to connect the City of Pittsburgh to Coraopolis and the Montour Trail system (11.25 mile alignment). The study proposes improvements for people who walk and people who bike within each town and along the project corridor.

Completing this project is of particular benefit to those living in Pittsburgh's west neighborhoods due to transit cut backs and since many here do not have access to a car. A walk-able and bike-able community offers multiple transportation choices to all citizens regardless of age, ability, or socio-economic status; provides for healthier travel choices (walking and bicycling); and increases access to employment centers and community resources.

The study recommends improvements to intersection crossings, ADA upgrades, sidewalk extensions to reconnect each town's street grid, and the addition of bike lanes, bicycle 'share-the-road' markings, and a separated bicycle track from the Corliss Tunnel to Station Square.

The completion of a safe route for walkers and bicyclists will provide opportunities for all. Your continued support in making our communities better places to live, work and play is appreciated.

Sincerely,
MACKIN ENGINEERING COMPANY

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads "RW Genter".

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
rwg@mackinengineering.com

RWG/pak
Enclosure



Project Status Reports



ORT Project Report May 23, 2012

Tom,

Project Activities:

1. As you know, the Mackin Team rode the entire alignment: field notes, photographed, and reviewed alternatives alignments in the field.
2. Attended and presented at municipal meeting with Committee and County Executive - May 2, 2012
3. Received GIS data from the County
4. Received Preston Bridge email report from Dave Wright
5. Received SGA plan files for Coraopolis Alignment
6. Received digital plans from Riverlife. Shows access under RR, pad and ramp to bridge crossing. Most of their work was on North Shore. It looks like they are using the existing barge access underpass to get to the other side of the RR tracks- which is currently posted as No Trespassing- used for barge tie-off and access. **Attached is scanned image of what was sent.**
7. JMT is sending the Rt 51 plans after their June 7 meeting with the City. It will show pedestrian access routes, walks and crossings; and a share the road sign for bikes on a 14' wide lane. The new road is to be 14' lane west, center turning lane to Corliss Tunnel, 14' lane east. I questioned JMT why not 'sharrows' and Lisa Cooper said Bike Pgh didn't want them; they wanted a 4' bike lane. DOT said no bike lane.
8. We requested traffic signal permit plans from PennDOT for appropriate intersections- not received yet
9. I met with Kim Perl of AGF in McKees Rocks- Bottoms. They own a 4 ac. parcel and a supply business adjacent to RR and were interested in the project. AGF has two railroad trail engines and a car and is interested in opportunities for their reuse.

Next- we will be meeting with:

- Trinity Commercial Development- McKees Rocks developer
- Neville Green for coordination of alignments on island

Can the committee provide the following?

1. List of Key Stakeholders (20 person max) with contact information
2. **Kick Off Meeting Date?** (We would like to begin discussion with Key Stakeholders prior to Kick Off)
3. Tentative dates for 3 public meetings
4. We requested SPC GIS data for the pedbike map alignments along SR 51- did not receive any yet (pdf is on web- can not use in GIS mapping system).

Also, we want to have a discussion with Committee (City, RR, SPC,?) about Land Ownership between RR and Ohio River. What are your thoughts for organizing a meeting?

Are you attending PennDOT Rt 51 project meeting on June 7?

Thanks,
Bob

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company
117 Industry Drive
RIDC Park West
Pittsburgh, PA 15275
V-412.788.0472
C-412.496.9210
rwg@mackinengineering.com

From: Bob Genter
Sent: Friday, May 04, 2012 11:17 AM
To: Thomas Baxter
Subject: Re: FOR - Ohio

Thank you
Sent on the Sprint® Now Network from my BlackBerry®

From: "Thomas Baxter" <thomas@friendsoftheriverfront.org>
Date: Fri, 4 May 2012 10:04:18 -0400
To: 'Bob Genter' <rwg@mackinengineering.com>
Subject: RE: FOR - Ohio

Let me know if you don't get what you need by Tuesday. I called and they said it shouldn't be an issue.

Tom

Thomas E. Baxter IV
Executive Director
Friends of the Riverfront, Inc.
33 Terminal Way, Suite 333B
Pittsburgh, PA 15219
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Connect with Friends of the Riverfront
[Facebook](#) | [Twitter](#) | friendsoftheriverfront.org

From: Bob Genter [mailto:rwg@mackinengineering.com]

Sent: Thursday, May 03, 2012 12:18 PM

To: Thomas Baxter

Subject: RE: FOR - Ohio

Yes I will

Can you contact PennDOT (JMT) to get their plans for the **bikeway along SR 51**? I think this request would be better first coming you- I can follow up once they agree to sending info/maps to Friends of the Riverfront.

We want their improvements plans; and the following data: ADT's, average speed analysis, and crash data if available.

Thank you,
Bob

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company
117 Industry Drive
RIDC Park West
Pittsburgh, PA 15275
V-412.788.0472
C-412.496.9210
rwg@mackinengineering.com

From: Thomas Baxter [mailto:thomas@friendsoftheriverfront.org]

Sent: Thursday, May 03, 2012 12:12 PM

To: Bob Genter

Subject: FOR - Ohio

Bob, just spoke with Lisa Schroeder, Director, of Riverlife. They have done some work around the West End Bridge that may plan into our Ohio Trail Plan. Will you reach out to Ed Patton to discuss. He knows you are contacting him concerning this project. Thanks

Edward Patton
Director of Capital Projects
Riverlife
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Tom

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Ohio River Trail (ORT) Feasibility Study
Project Report July 10, 2012

ORT Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed and Next activities:

1. Mackin Team rode the entire alignment: field notes, photographed, and reviewed alternatives alignments in the field.
2. May 2, 2012- Municipal Meeting with Committee and County Executive
3. June 18, 2012- Committee Steering Meeting Kick-Off
4. Revised alignment maps based on field reviews and interviews to date
5. Received the following data:
 - Traffic signal plans from PennDOT
 - GIS data from the County
 - Preston Bridge email report from Dave Wright
 - SGA plan files for Coraopolis alignment
 - Route 51 PennDOT plans
 - Riverlife plans- the plan show access to subject alignment under existing RR; it looks like they are using the existing barge access underpass to get to the other side (land side) of the RR tracks- underpass is currently posted as No Trespassing and used for barge tie-off and access operation. **Current Riverlife Plans will not connect to this alignment.**
 - Received CSX easement from Craig Rippole for RR property
6. Issued Key Person list & interview questions to committee for review and comment. Have not received any formal comments on interview questions. Have received finalize list of contact persons- Sam is completing 2-contact phone numbers.

Next:

- Continue phone interviews
- Set field meeting times with communities- (following phone interviews)
- Meet with PennDOT to review West End alignment- Committee to organize the meeting.
- Begin Draft Report

Thank you,
Bob

Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Ohio River Trail (ORT) Feasibility Study Project Report August 7, 2012

ORT Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed:

1. Continue to complete Key Person phone interviews
 - 11 of the 20 interviews have been completed; some emails have been returned; we will have to follow up with phone calls.
2. Alignment mapping has been updated with details for the ORT main line, local loops, bus stops, ADT, and posted MPH.
 - Alignment maps will indicate type of proposed bicycle facility
 1. BIKE ROUTE
 2. BIKE 'SHARROW'
 3. BIKE LANE
3. Received the Preston Bridge report from Dave Wright. A **Second alternative alignment has been delineated using McKee's Rocks Bridge to access 'Bottoms'**.
4. An alternative (low volume) route under the McKees Rock Bridge has been delineated to avoid high speed and high volume traffic from Bridge to Tunnel Way.
5. Received Route SR 51 PennDOT plans- **SR 51 plans allow for 3-14' wide lanes from West End Bridge to Corliss Tunnel and continuing from Corliss to McKees Rocks**; there are no bike lanes, routes or sharrows marked. We did not receive signing or pavement marking plans.
6. Received Riverlife plans- **Current Riverlife Plans will not connect to this alignment.**
7. *The proposed alignment uses State & Local Road ROW's. These alignments are all on-street facilities; there are no off-street trails proposed due to the existing conditions of hillside, roads, railroads, private property and river.*

Next Activities:

- Complete phone interviews
- Set field meeting times with communities- (following phone interviews)
- Meet with PennDOT to review West End alignment- Committee to organize the meeting.
- Committee to set tentative dates for 2 public meetings
- Begin Draft Report

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (3RHT) Feasibility Study
Ohio River Section

Project Report October 19, 2012

ORT Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed:

1. Completed Key Person phone interviews
2. Alignment mapping has been updated with details for municipal names, 3RHT main line, alternative routes, local loops, bus stops, ADT, and posted MPH. Alignment maps will indicate an on-road bicycle facility including:
 - a. BIKE ROUTES
 - b. 'SHARROWS'- BIKE SHARED LANE MARKINGS (SLM)
 - c. BIKE LANES
3. Completed Neville, Coraopolis, Stowe and McKees Rocks field reviews with project sponsor, municipal and neighborhood representatives
4. Draft Report is approx. 75% complete, less committee review & edits

Next Items:

1. Submit Draft for committee review
2. Meet with PennDOT to review West End alignment- Committee to organize the meeting
3. Committee to set tentative dates for public meeting
4. Complete Report

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (3RHT) Feasibility Study
Ohio River Section
Project Report November 6, 2012

ORT Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed:

1. Completed the following meetings:
 - a. Kick-Off Meeting with 7-Municipalities at Father Ryan Arts Center- May 2, 2012
 - b. Stakeholder Meeting at St. Mary Ukrainian Orthodox Church- June 18, 2012
 - c. Municipal Field Meetings
 - i. August 29, 2012 with Neville and Coraopolis
 - ii. September 21, 2012 with McKee's Rocks and Stowe Township
 - d. Direct Steering Committee Meeting- Draft Review at Friends of Riverfront Office- November 5, 2012
2. Completed 20-Key Persons phone interviews
3. Alignment mapping has been updated with details for municipal names, 3RHT connector route, alternative routes, local loops, bus stops, ADT, and posted MPH. Alignment maps will indicate an on-road walking & bicycle facility including:
 - a. BIKE ROUTES
 - b. 'SHARROWS' - BIKE SHARED LANE MARKINGS (SLM)
 - c. BIKE LANES
 - d. WALK AND CROSSING IMPROVEMENTS AT KEY INTERSECTIONS
4. Draft Report is approx. 75% complete, less committee review & edits

Next Items:

1. Project Steering Committee Meeting to be held December 3, 2012- Committee to set final arrangements (review recommended routes and draft report findings).
2. Submit Final Draft to committee for review
3. Public Meeting (open house forum)- Committee to finalize arrangements; tentative date in January 2013
4. Mackin to send aerial image maps of West End to Tom; Tom to set meeting with PennDOT to review West End alignment (Steering Committee to organize the meeting)
5. Complete and Submit Final Report

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (3RHT) Feasibility Study
Pittsburgh to Coraopolis
Project Report December 31, 2012

Ohio River Trail (ORT) Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed:

1. Completed the following meetings:
 - a. May 2, 2012- Kick-Off Meeting with 7-Municipalities at Father Ryan Arts Center
 - b. June 18, 2012- Stakeholder Meeting at St. Mary Ukrainian Orthodox Church
 - c. Municipal Field Meetings
 - i. August 29, 2012 with Neville and Coraopolis
 - ii. September 21, 2012 with McKee's Rocks and Stowe Township
 - d. November 5, 2012- Direct Steering Committee Meeting; Draft Review at Friends of Riverfront (F.O.R.) Office
 - e. December 11, 2012- Project Steering Committee Meeting; Review of Draft Plans at McKeesport Borough Office
2. Completed 20-Key Persons phone interviews
3. Alignment mapping has been updated with details for municipal names, 3RHT connector route, alternative routes, local loops, bus stops, ADT, and posted MPH. Alignment maps will indicate an on-road walking & bicycle facility including:
 - a. BIKE ROUTES
 - b. 'SHARROWS'- BIKE SHARED LANE MARKINGS (SLM)
 - c. BIKE LANES
 - d. WALK AND CROSSING IMPROVEMENTS AT KEY INTERSECTIONS
4. Draft Report is approx. 90% complete, less committee review & edits. The executive summary, maps, & improvement images were posted on project FTP site and a hard copy mailed to F.O.R.
5. Draft letters were sent to F.O.R. for submission to City and County notifying each about project specifics; Route 51 proposed improvements and Fleming Park Bridge respectively.

Next Items:

1. F.O.R. to set meeting with City to review trail proposal at Rt 51 between Pgh and McKees Rocks
2. Mackin to submit completed Draft to committee for Final Review
3. Public Meeting (open house forum)- Committee to finalize arrangements; tentative date in January 2013
4. Complete and Submit Final Report

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (3RHT) Feasibility Study
Pittsburgh to Coraopolis
Project Report APRIL 2013

Ohio River Trail (ORT) Committee:

Listed below are activities that have been completed:

1. Completed 20-Key Persons phone interviews
2. Completed the following meetings:
 - a. May 2, 2012- Kick-Off Meeting with 7-Municipalities at Father Ryan Arts Center
 - b. June 18, 2012- Stakeholder Meeting at St. Mary Ukrainian Orthodox Church
 - c. Municipal Field Meetings
 - i. August 29, 2012 with Neville and Coraopolis
 - ii. September 21, 2012 with McKee's Rocks and Stowe Township
 - d. November 5, 2012- Direct Steering Committee Meeting; Draft Review at Friends of Riverfront (F.O.R.) Office
 - e. December 11, 2012- Project Steering Committee Meeting; Review of Draft Plans at McKeesport Borough Office
 - f. *April 4, 2013- Direct Steering Committee Meeting Friends of Riverfront (F.O.R.) to review changes to alignment by Stowe/McKees Rocks and review the project status.*
3. Completed and posted the feasibility study- executive summary, graphics, maps, costs in November 2012; updated FTP in Dec, Jan, March & April.
4. Completed and submitted a draft copy of the report and provided hard copy plans, graphics, costs to F.O.R., Tom Baxter, for submission to Patrick Hassett at City of Pittsburgh; December 18, 2012.
5. Extra draft letters were sent to F.O.R. for submission to City and County notifying each about project specifics; Route 51 proposed improvements and Fleming Park Bridge respectively. Extra letter were sent to Taris Vrcek & Trish Lavander at McKees Rocks to notify planning commission for a 'complete streets' approach when approving developments, and for additional route reviews respectively.
6. The project was scheduled for completion in January 2013- Additional meetings, correspondence, project management, and map printing requests will be invoiced as additional costs under billing code -002.
7. *After this April meeting, the report is to be amended for the Stowe-McKees Rocks alignment and then posted on FTP site for F.O.R. distribution and final review.*

Next Items:

1. Extra meeting was requested- to meet with Steve Shanley at County on April 23, 2013.
2. Public Meeting (open house forum)- Committee to complete arrangements for final meeting
3. Edit and submit final report

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company



Three Rivers Heritage Trail (3RHT) Feasibility Study
Pittsburgh to Coraopolis
Project Report MAY 2013

To: Ohio River Trail (ORT) Committee

Status:

Completed- same as April Report with below additions

Recently completed:

1. Attended extra meeting with McKees Rocks Borough representatives; met with T. Levander, C. Rippole, and T. Vrcek on May 29, 2013 to again review route.
 - a. Agreement was reached to show the 'Rocks' local loop route stopped at the intersection of Chartiers, Linden, Furnace; and to just write about future extension of the route into central business district.
 - b. Agreement was reached to show preferred route in 'Bottoms' along Helen to the green space-parklet at McKees Rocks Bridge ramp and cross to Munson, George and enter bridge sidewalk system. The Bottom's local loop was submitted by Craig Rippole and approved by others.
2. Attended extra meeting with Steve Shanley, et.al at County on April 23, 2013.
3. Report completion was pending review and comments from City- Pat Hassett (April).
4. Executive Summary was completed and posted on FTP site (April).

Next Items:

1. Public Meeting (open house forum) to be held at the Stowe Municipal Bldg at 6pm on Wednesday, June 19, 2013.
2. Post final report on FTP for review and comment.

Thank you,
Robert W. Genter, RLA, ASLA
Director- Land Development Services
Mackin Engineering Company